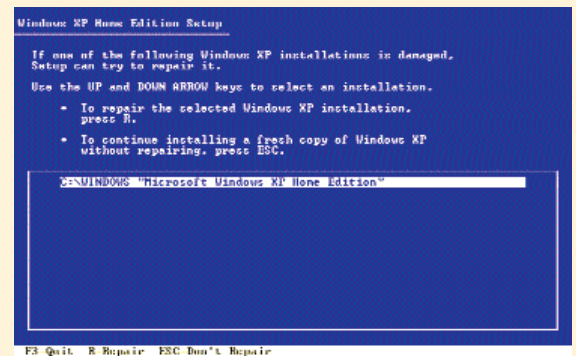


Installing Windows XP requires you to be at your computer. Is there a way to do away with this, and automate the installation?

Write in with the subject "Take a crack", and your postal address, to takeacrack@thinkdigit.com with your solution

Automate the installation of Windows XP



LAST MONTH'S CHALLENGE



Take a Crack and win

Ajax In Action

by Dava Crane
Eric Pascarello
with Darren Janes

Published by **WILEY-INDIA**

LAST MONTH'S WINNER

**Murtuza A
Zabuawala**
Dahod, Gujarat

Rules and Regulations

Readers are requested to send in their answers by the 15th of the month of publication.

Employees of Jasubhai Digital Media and their relatives are not permitted to participate in this contest.

Readers are encouraged to send their replies by e-mail. Jasubhai Digital Media will not entertain any unsolicited communication.

Jasubhai Digital Media is not responsible for any damage to your system that may be caused while you are trying to solve the problem.

Without using a third-party tool, how would you display your company's logo on the Windows XP logon and shutdown screens?

We've only received a solution that *does* require a third-party tool. Here's how to display a logo in the Windows password screen:

Step 1: This crack needs a tool called Resource Hacker. You can download it for free from <http://rpi.net.au/~ajohnson/resourcehacker>

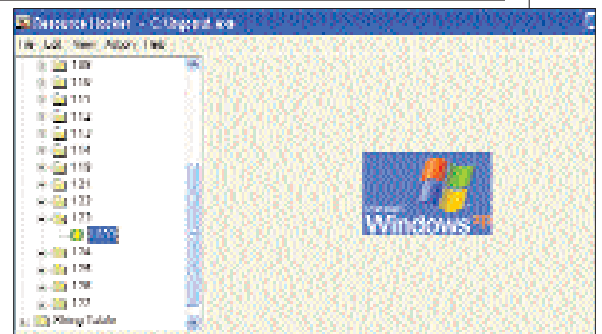
Step 2: Create a Restore Point for your System and back up important data.

Step 3: Open Resource Hacker. Go to Open in the File menu and type into the Open File text box: "X:\windows\system32\logonui.exe", where X is your Windows XP drive letter.

Step 4: You can now see a tree view of the decompiled logonui.exe file. Expand the Bitmap Section go for Name 123 there. You can now view the Windows XP logo. Right-click on 1033, which is in the 123 section.

Step 5: Right-click and select "Save [Bitmap: 123:1033]". Save this bitmap to your system. Open the bitmap in MSPaint or PhotoShop or any other image-editing program you want. Clear the image and create your company logo instead of the Windows XP logo. Save your file with the .bmp extension. The size of the photo must be 137 x 86—the same as the original. The same procedure goes for 127 in the Bitmap Tree: [Bitmap: 127:1033]

Step 6: Once you've created your logo, go to Bitmap 123 > 1033. Right-click on it and go to "Replace Resource..." This will open up a window. Click on "Open file for new Bitmap". Browse for and select your created bitmap. It will open in a second picture box. Click on the Replace button. Do the same for Bitmap > 127 > 1033; right-click on it and go to "Replace Resource..." This will open a



The tree view in Resource Hacker

window. Click on "Open file for new Bitmap". Browse for and select your created bitmap. It will open in a second picture box now. Click Replace. Save the file in X:\windows\system32\logonui.exe. (Replace the original file with your modified file.) You'll get a File Protection Error: "File is not recognized by Windows XP SP2. Please insert the Windows XP SP2 CD and click OK..." Just cancel the dialog box. (Press Cancel and then press Yes.)

That's it! Restart Windows and see the results of your magic!

If you also want change the "Welcome" string, go to the main tree view. Then go to STRING TABLE > 1 > 1033. Replace the string "Welcome" to your name or your company name or whatever!

Note: Before you replace your original .exe with the modified one, there's one thing that has to be done, otherwise Windows replace your files to their original form—Windows has inbuilt security for files, to prevent them from getting corrupted, as with logonui.exe. You need to apply a trick to bypass this protection. Open Notepad and type in the following:

```
del %systemroot%\system32\dllcache\logonui.exe
```

Save this file as "crack_logo.bat" and run it. Use this method at your own risk! ■